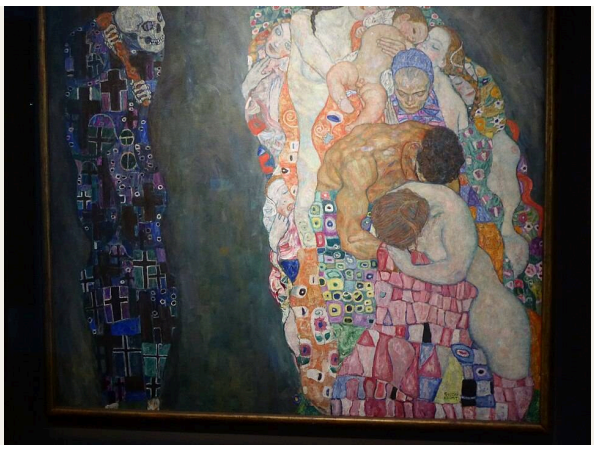
VIENNA, AUSTRIA

# Leopold Museum: Masterpieces

Bodies, trees and towns are held together by lines that rarely let them rest easily.



Schiele's bent limbs, bare branches and crowded roofs share a visible concern with the angle at which one part meets another. A contour can hold a figure together while making its position appear difficult. In Gerstl and Corinth, strokes loosen those boundaries, letting body and setting participate in the same active surface.

The selection begins with Klimt's *Death and Life*, where the interval between two groups matters as much as either group's decoration. That space introduces a recurring question: what separates figures, and what joins them? The answers vary between family groups, portraits, cultivated landscapes and a procession in which a skeleton moves among the living. No single mood adequately describes them all.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

## Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context  Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/leopold-museum

# The selection · 20

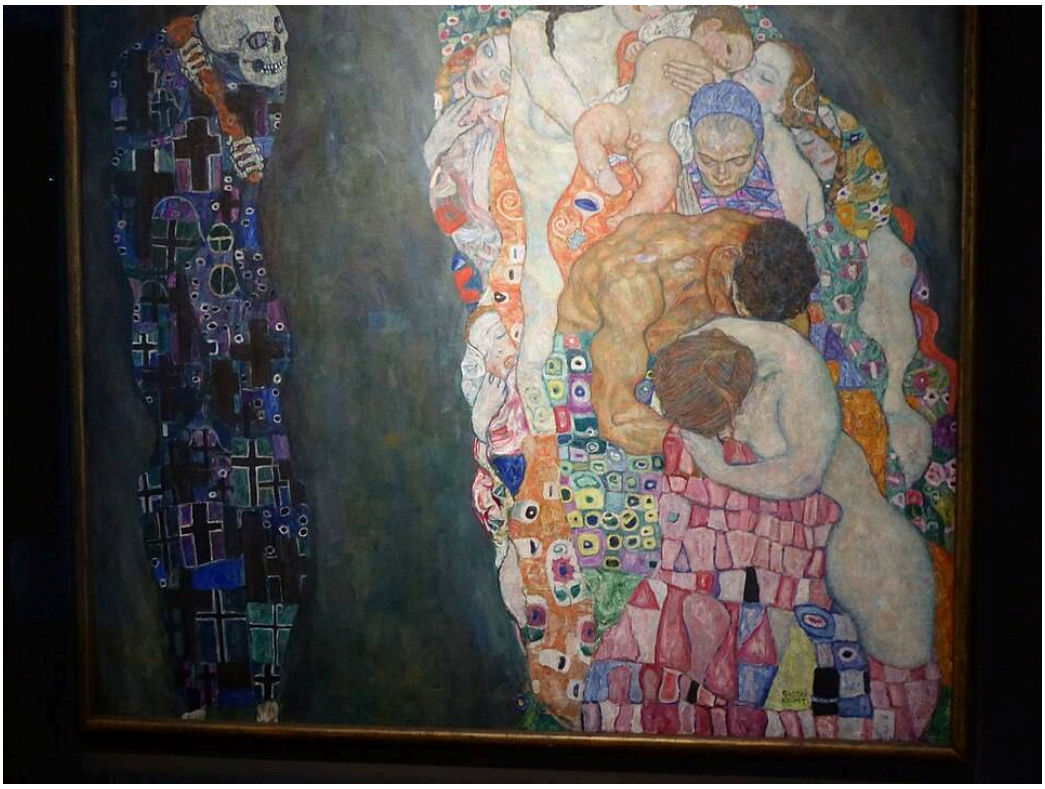
1. Death and Life
   Gustav Klimt · 1910/11, reworked in 1912/13 and 1915/16
2. Portrait of Wally
   Egon Schiele · 1912
3. Mother with Two Children II
   Egon Schiele · 1915
4. Seated Male Nude, Self-Portrait
   Egon Schiele · 1910
5. Self-Portrait with Bare Shoulder
   Egon Schiele · 1912
6. A Morning by the Pond
   Gustav Klimt · 1899
7. Cardinal and Nun, Caress
   Egon Schiele · 1912
8. Krumau on the Vltava, The Small Town IV
   Egon Schiele · 1913–1914
9. Covered Table
   Anton Faistauer · 1916
10. Danse Macabre, Version IV
    Albin Egger-Lienz · 1915
11. Farm in Barbizon
    Max Liebermann · 1874
12. Autumn Tree in Stirred Air, Winter Tree
    Egon Schiele · 1912
13. Lake Traun with the Sleeping Greek Woman Mountain
    Richard Gerstl · 1907
14. Landscape at the Walchensee
    Lovis Corinth · 1923
15. Setting Sun
    Egon Schiele · 1913
16. Alfred Kuhn
    Lovis Corinth · 1923
17. The Lyricist
    Egon Schiele · 1911
18. Henryka Cohn
    Richard Gerstl · 1908
19. Blind Mother, The Mother
    Egon Schiele · 1914
20. Sunny Meadow with Fruit Trees
    Richard Gerstl · c. 1908

01 / 20

# Death and Life

Gustav Klimt

1910/11, reworked in 1912/13 and 1915/16 · Leopold Museum



Gustav Klimt. Death and Life. Image credit: Ardfern; Own work. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Leopold_Museum,_Vienna,_September_2018_(05).jpg. CC BY-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 4.0

The skeletal figure stands apart from a closely packed group containing several ages of life. Dark cross-patterned clothing faces bright ornament and exposed skin across an empty interval. Klimt makes decoration serve both sides of the opposition. The gap keeps their relation unresolved in space: death belongs to the composition while remaining outside the living group's bodily enclosure.

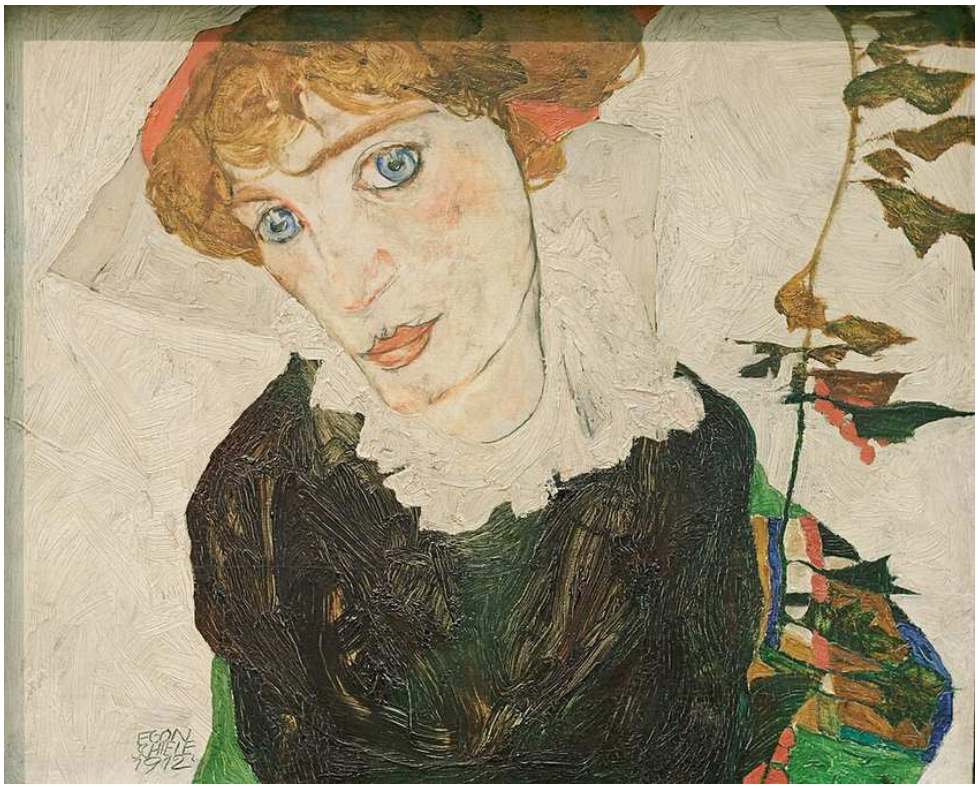
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 630

02 / 20

# Portrait of Wally

Egon Schiele

1912 · Leopold Museum




Egon Schiele. Portrait of Wally. Image credit: Egon Schiele; Own work; Photographic credit: Yelkrokoyade. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Portrait_of_Wally_Neuzil_Egon_Schiele_1912.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

Red hair, blue eyes and the pale collar give the face distinct points of orientation against its lightly worked surroundings. The inclined head complicates the direct gaze, making the encounter less symmetrical than a formal frontal portrait. Schiele concentrates description where recognition needs it, leaving the garment and background to provide a sharper, simpler frame around the likeness.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 453

03 / 20

# Mother with Two Children II

Egon Schiele

1915 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. Mother with Two Children II. Image credit: Egon Schiele; Own work; Photographic credit: Yelkrokoyade. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Mother_with_two_children_II_Egon_Schiele_1915.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

The bodies overlap, yet the faces retain separate directions and definitions. Angular boundaries prevent the family from settling into a single softened shape. Schiele lets the narrow group remain a combination of individuals whose physical proximity requires arrangement. Closeness is present, but it does not automatically remove the distinctions among the people held together.

Object source · Open artwork

04 / 20

# Seated Male Nude, Self-Portrait

Egon Schiele

1910 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. Seated Male Nude (Self-Portrait). Image credit: Egon Schiele; Own work , Yelkrokoyade , 2012-07-13 12:27:42. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Seated_male_nude_(Self-Portrait)_Egon_Schiele_1910.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

Raised arms and extended legs leave the body's angles conspicuous against an almost empty ground. There is little furniture or room to explain and support the pose. Schiele makes the self-portrait depend on the articulated structure itself. Isolation amplifies each turn at a joint, allowing strain to be read without a surrounding narrative of suffering.

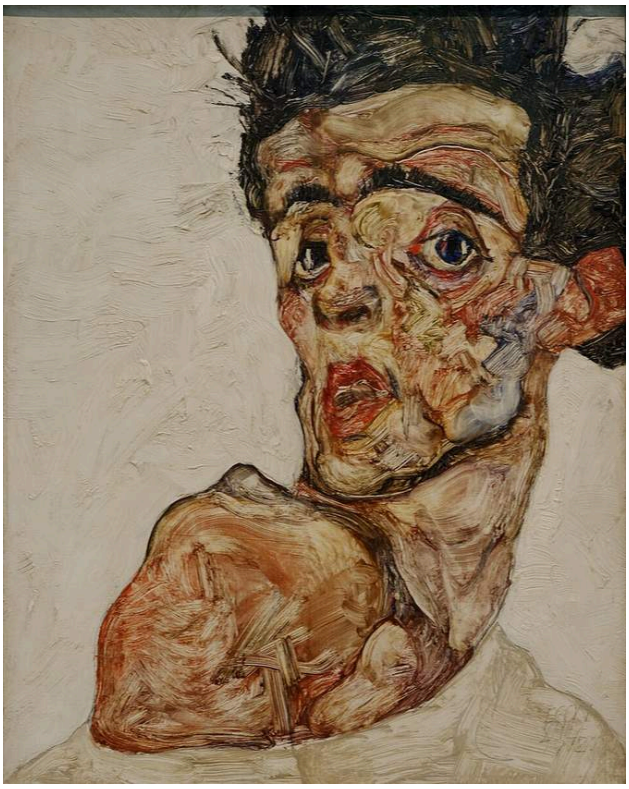
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Inv. 465

05 / 20

# Self-Portrait with Bare Shoulder

Egon Schiele

1912 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. Self-Portrait with Bare Shoulder. Image credit: Egon Schiele; Own work , Yelkrokoyade , 2012-07-13 12:21:57. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Self_portrait_with_raised_bare_shoulder_Egon_Schiele_1912.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

The shoulder claims an unusually forceful position beneath the turned face. Its pale mass competes with the features rather than quietly supporting them. Dark hair and emphatic boundaries interrupt the skin, preventing a smooth passage around the head. A small amount of exposed body is enough to disturb the portrait's expected hierarchy of attention.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Inv.Nr 653

06 / 20

# A Morning by the Pond

Gustav Klimt

1899 · Leopold Museum



Gustav Klimt. A Morning by the Pond. WikiArt: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt per-object label)

The vegetation returns in the water with its arrangement retained and its texture softened. Klimt makes reflection a variation rather than a simple duplicate. A lighter distance appears beyond the dark bank, adding another horizontal interval. The landscape can be followed through repeated forms and differences in clarity without needing a prominent figure or event.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 2007

07 / 20

# Cardinal and Nun, Caress

Egon Schiele

1912 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. Cardinal and Nun (Caress). Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Pale faces and hands emerge from a steep mass of red and dark robes. The clothing's rigid shapes make the embrace look awkward rather than yielding. Religious dress gives the contact a significance beyond the bodily gesture alone. Schiele allows those signals to remain in tension: the figures cling together while the costume keeps their roles insistently visible.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 455

08 / 20

# Krumau on the Vltava, The Small Town IV

Egon Schiele

1913–1914 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. Krumau on the Vltava (The Small Town IV). Image credit: Egon Schiele; Own work , Yelkrokoyade , Taken in 13 July 2012, 13:30:27. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Krumau_on_the_Moldova_(Small_town_IV)_Egon_Schiele_1914.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

Roofs, windows and narrow passages fit into a steeply tilted view above a dark river band. The town is inhabited in its structures even without prominent human activity. Schiele gives architecture an articulation comparable to his bodies: adjoining angles hold the image together while making its compression apparent. The river supplies a firm boundary beneath the crowded forms.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 655

09 / 20

# Covered Table

Anton Faistauer

1916 · Leopold Museum



Anton Faistauer · The Yorck Project (2002) 10.000 Meisterwerke der Malerei (DVD-ROM), distributed by DIRECTMEDIA Publishing GmbH. ISBN: 3936122202. · Public domain · Wikimedia Commons · Public domain

The tabletop tips toward the viewer, bringing dishes and fruit forward against the darker room. Chairs establish places for people who are not shown. Faistauer gives the meal a material arrangement before it becomes a social event. Broad colour areas make the objects substantial, while the white cloth gathers them into one sloping field.

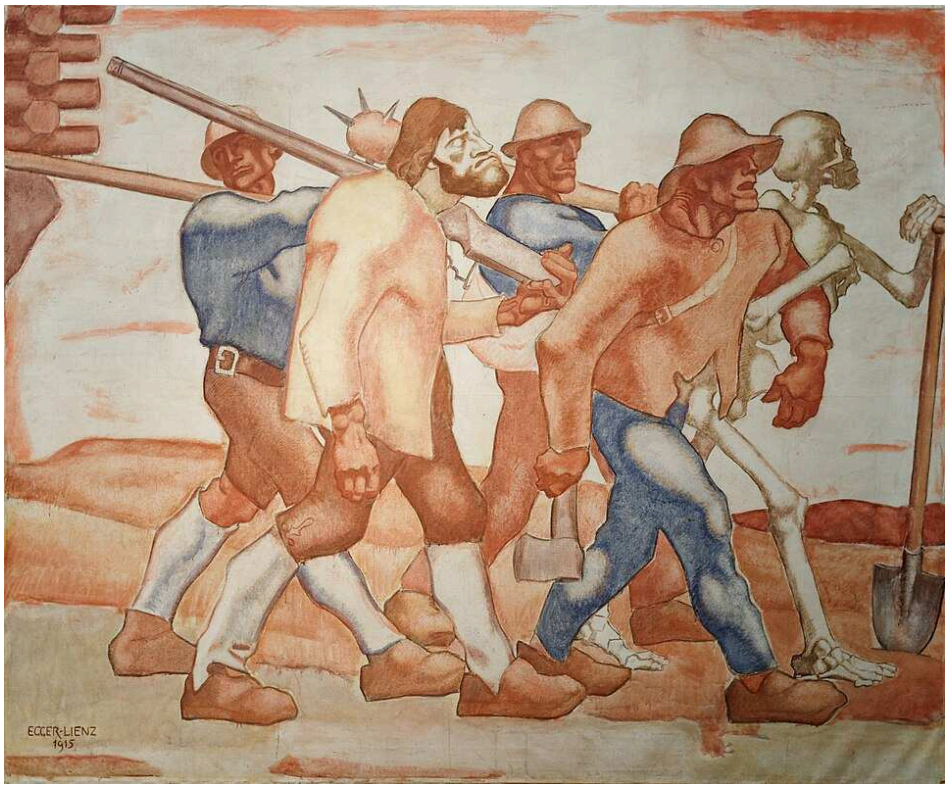
Object source · Open artwork

10 / 20

# Danse Macabre, Version IV

Albin Egger-Lienz

1915 · Leopold Museum




Albin Egger-Lienz. Danse Macabre (version IV). Image credit: Albin Egger-Lienz; Own work , Yelkrokoyade , 2012-07-13 13:33:07. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Danse_macabre_(fourth_Version)_Albin_Egger-Lienz.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

The skeleton follows the same stride as the tool-bearing men. Repeated bent limbs join them into a procession across shallow earth colours. Egger-Lienz does not place death in a separate zone watching the living from afar. It participates in their movement, making the shared rhythm more consequential than any one individual's identity.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Inv. 195

11 / 20

# Farm in Barbizon

Max Liebermann

1874 · Leopold Museum



Max Liebermann. Farm in Barbizon. Image credit: Derbrauni; Own work. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Max_Liebermann_-_Bauernhof_in_Barbizon.jpg. CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY 4.0

Scattered geese interrupt the yard's relation to its low buildings and steep roof. Their differing positions make it an occupied working space rather than a simple architectural prospect. Liebermann gives uneven ground many tonal changes, allowing ordinary farm activity to remain embedded in its material conditions. The birds' modest movements keep the foreground from becoming static.

Object source · Open artwork

12 / 20

# Autumn Tree in Stirred Air, Winter Tree

Egon Schiele

1912 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. Autumn Tree in Stirred Air (Winter Tree). Image credit: Egon Schiele; Own work; Photographic credit: Yelkrokoyade. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Automn_Tree_in_Stirred_Air_(Winter_Tree)_Egon_Schiele_1912.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

With little foliage to soften them, the branches disclose every change of direction. A dark ground strip anchors the trunk against the pale, broken setting. Schiele gives the tree something of a drawn body's articulation without requiring a literal human identity. The comparison concerns visible structure: support below, repeated joints above, and pressure carried through an uneven contour.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 449

13 / 20

# Lake Traun with the Sleeping Greek Woman Mountain

Richard Gerstl

1907 · Leopold Museum



Richard Gerstl. Lake Traunsee with the Schlafende Griechin mountain. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Curling strokes cross mountain and sky, making their surfaces share an activity the terrain itself cannot literally perform. Gerstl preserves the mass of the blue-green slopes above the narrow lake while loosening their description. The picture holds two kinds of information together, a recognisable landscape and the movements of paint through which it has been found.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 646

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# Landscape at the Walchensee

Lovis Corinth

1923 · Leopold Museum



Lovis Corinth. Landscape at the Walchensee. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Hillside, buildings and lake remain the view's principal divisions, but slanting strokes repeatedly interrupt their edges. Corinth does not smooth the handling into a seamless prospect. The landscape has to be seen through an active painted surface. Darker marks across the upper distance keep that activity present even where the eye expects the view to recede.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 109

15 / 20

# Setting Sun

Egon Schiele

1913 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. Setting Sun. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Thin trunks and dark branches cut across bands of land, water and warm sky. The two structures, upright trees and horizontal distance, remain visibly distinct. Schiele allows the sunset's warmth to occupy the view without dissolving its firm divisions. Colour supplies a condition of light, but contour continues to determine where one part stops and another begins.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 625

16 / 20

# Alfred Kuhn

Lovis Corinth

1923 · Leopold Museum



Lovis Corinth. Portrait of Alfred Kuhn. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The turned face emerges through tonal contrast while diagonal strokes continue from clothes into background. Corinth gives the sitter substance without sealing every outer edge. The shared handling joins person and setting, but the light preserves their difference. A portrait can remain solid even when the marks that describe it are plainly visible as marks.

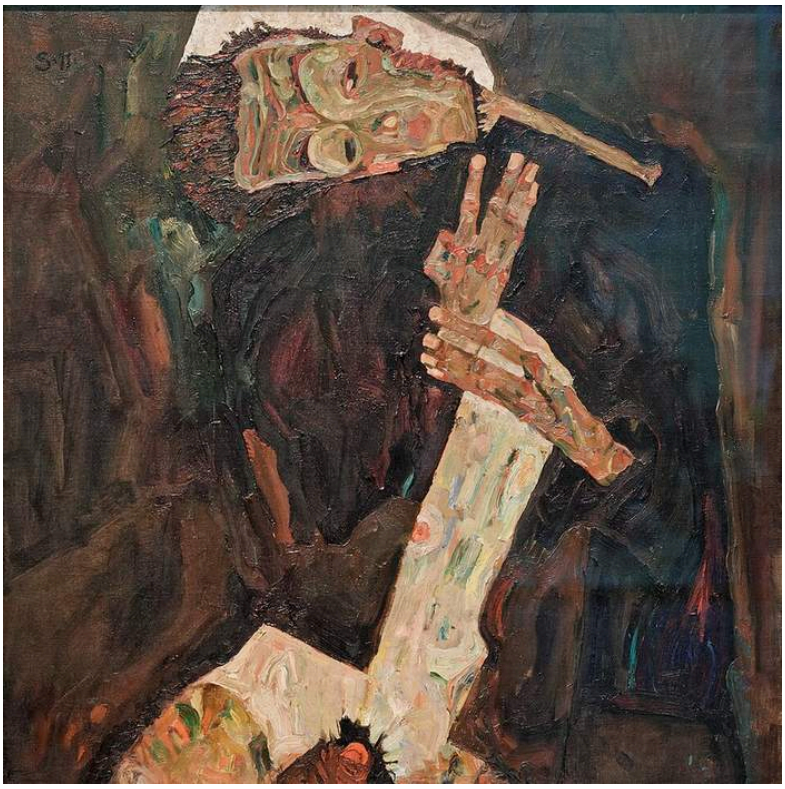
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 2091

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# The Lyricist

Egon Schiele

1911 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. The Lyricist. Image credit: Yelkrokoyade; Own work. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:The_Lyricist_Egon_Schiele_1911.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

Spread fingers extend the figure's presentation beyond the tilted head. Pale skin, crossed by coloured marks and broken edges, separates those gestures from the darker body. Schiele makes self-presentation a visible performance rather than a settled likeness. The hands ask for attention in their own right, giving the portrait a direction that the face alone would not establish.

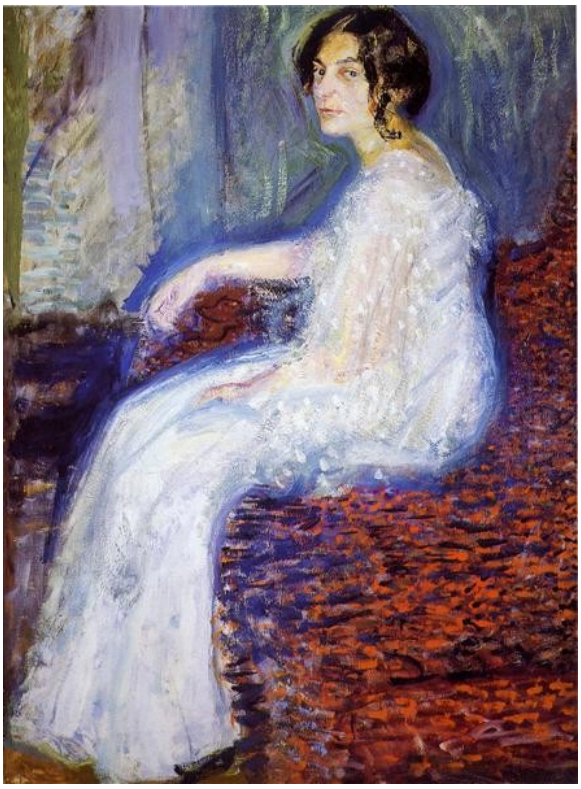
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 450

18 / 20

# Henryka Cohn

Richard Gerstl

1908 · Leopold Museum



Richard Gerstl. Portrait of Henryka Cohn. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Cool blue and violet pass between the sideways sitter and the patterned room. Gerstl reduces the separation of surfaces without losing the pose. The pale dress belongs both to a recognisable body and to a larger distribution of colour. This shared treatment makes the interior active within the portrait instead of serving as a neutral container.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: LM 650

19 / 20

# Blind Mother, The Mother

Egon Schiele

1914 · Leopold Museum



Egon Schiele. Blind Mother, or The Mother. Image credit: Egon Schiele; Own work; Photographic credit: Yelkrokoyade. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Blind_Mother_Egon_Schiele_1914.jpg. CC BY-SA 3.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 3.0

The woman bends over the child within a dark, closely bounded setting. Heavy contours connect bodies, clothes and furniture into a protective but awkward structure. Schiele gives care a material difficulty: the figures must fit and support one another in the space available. The subject's tenderness need not depend on making that arrangement appear relaxed.

Object source · Open artwork

20 / 20

# Sunny Meadow with Fruit Trees

Richard Gerstl

c. 1908 · Leopold Museum



Richard Gerstl. Sunny Meadow with Fruit Trees. WikiArt: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt per-object label)

Repeated strokes make a dense green field around trunks and spreading branches. Patches of light interrupt the accumulation without clearing it into a polished prospect. Gerstl keeps the sunny landscape materially substantial, with the eye encountering paint as persistently as foliage. Bright subject matter and forceful handling coexist rather than requiring the same emotional register.

Object source · Open artwork

# Follow a contour across subjects

Compare a bare branch with a bent arm, or a roof angle with a folded garment. The resemblance is a way to examine structure, not proof that each subject conceals the same meaning. For an in-person visit, verify the particular work and current display through the museum; this selection records collection objects rather than a permanent route.

# Further reading

## The Practice and Science of Drawing

Harold Speed · Read free · English

Speed’s account of line and mass provides a practical starting point for Schiele’s contours. His more conventional examples also make the departures in these paintings easier to describe.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12

Artline · Leopold Museum: Masterpieces